# Workshop briefs: reading-based revision sheets

Author/session briefs, English edition

These sheets are taken from Part 6 of the *Making Commons Dynamic* study companion. No session schedule or speaker list was available, so the sheets are organised by reading. The background to every question is in the matching chapter of the book. Page references follow the printed journal pages.

## W02 · Ostrom et al. (1999) Revisiting the Commons

**Must know**

1. CPR = costly exclusion + subtractability; separate from rights regimes (p.278–279).
2. Four rights regimes (Table 1); none is best everywhere.
3. Both access limits and investment incentives are needed (halibut).
4. Four behavioural types; reciprocity and reputation.
5. Nepal: higher cropping intensity under farmer ownership (Table 2).
6. Six challenges of global commons.

**Questions**

a. How could “institutional diversity” be measured?

b. How was the siting (selection) of government systems controlled for in the Nepal comparison?

c. What is your view today on the distributional consequences of exclusion?

**Notes**

## W03 · Ostrom (2007) Diagnostic approach / W04 · Ostrom (2009) SES framework

**Must know**

1. Panacea = a universal solution without diagnosis.
2. Partial decomposability: classes and subclasses, separable subsystems, emergent properties.
3. Hardin’s five assumptions; face-to-face talk raises cooperation.
4. Roving bandits vs Maine lobster; the V-notch.
5. Ten variables; effects are non-linear and interdependent.
6. W04 Table 1 adapted from W03; the PDF includes pages of other articles.

**Questions**

a. By what criterion were the ten variables chosen?

b. How should RS2 (boundaries) be defined in a seasonal floodplain fishery?

c. How can misuse of the framework as a checklist be prevented?

**Notes**

## W05 · Agrawal, Erbaugh & Pradhan (2023) The Commons

**Must know**

1. Three lasting contributions (§1).
2. The definition of commons is governance-based (first sentence).
3. Three self-criticisms: single-resource focus, stability bias, neglect of identity (§2.2.2).
4. Only 36 of 172 studies had >30 observations (§2.3.1).
5. Three eras; commoning; big data.

**Questions**

a. What data infrastructure is needed to overcome “stability bias”?

b. How can the value-driven side of the commoning literature and descriptive science work together?

c. Why are South Asian floodplain fisheries so thin in the review?

**Notes**

## W06 · Nayak & Berkes (2011) Chilika

**Must know**

1. Definitions of commonisation/decommonisation (p.132).
2. Table 1 (8 factors) and Table 4 (11 factors).
3. Pathway: commons → decommonisation → open access → privatisation (p.141).
4. Bundle of rights vs bundle of powers (p.142).
5. Table 5: mixed property regimes.
6. Design: two villages = a comparison of stages.

**Questions**

a. What data would have separated the effects of the market driver and the 2001 new sea mouth?

b. Was the Tata area 600 or 1,100 ha; was FISHFED 1988 or 1991?

c. How would you handle the inequality of caste-based exclusion when aiming to “keep commons as commons”?

**Notes**

## W07 · Galappaththi & Nayak (2017) Two faces of shrimp aquaculture

**Must know**

1. Definition of a “wicked driver”.
2. Sri Lanka: three lagoons + Dutch canal = shared water.
3. Disease crisis → associations → SLADA + NAQDA → zonal crop calendar.
4. Seven commonising and eight decommonising factors.
5. Case selection: compatible methods and time frame.

**Questions**

a. Has the new shrimp commons reduced lagoon capture fishers’ access?

b. Evidence of success is national production; are there time series of disease or water quality in the case areas?

c. Which third case would you add if designing the study today?

**Notes**

## W09 · Nayak & Berkes (2022) / W08 · Nayak (2021) / W10 · Berkes & Franz (2025) ch.5

**Must know**

1. Model: two-way continuum, three trajectories, multilevel drivers.
2. “Favourable” is a declared value.
3. Source of “ephemeral commons”: W08 ch.4 (Singh), W09 §5.
4. The SSF Guidelines’ “tenure rights” = the policy form of commons rights language.
5. 11 design principles; critique of ITQs; roving bandits; coastal grabbing.

**Questions**

a. How would you measure the degree of commonisation?

b. Is the workshop’s “ephemeral” meant hydrologically-temporally or institutionally?

c. How do “prediction is possible” (W10 §5.7) and the case against panaceas (W03) fit together?

**Notes**

## Post-session reflection form

**Form to fill in after each session.**

| Question | Your answer |
|---|---|
| What was the speaker’s newest claim that was not in the text? | |
| On which rung of evidence (Figure 6.1) does that claim stand? | |
| Which of my assumptions changed? | |
| Which question went unanswered? | |
| One transferable piece of reasoning (not an analogy) for my research | |